



FOR MORE
STORIES

« Every match you play at the highest level is an opportunity to go somewhere »

RUTURAJ GAIKWAD

Shayan Acharya

shayan.acharya@thehindu.co.in

Ruturaj Gaikwad has never been one for grand statements. Through the highs of leading Chennai Super Kings, the setbacks of injuries and the

uncertainty of life on the fringes of the Indian team, the stylish batter has remained calm and composed.

Rather than dwelling on missed opportunities or selection debates, Gaikwad prefers to focus on the next chance to make an impact.

His recent performances offered another reminder of that resilience. Returning to List A cricket after IPL 2026, Gaikwad starred in the India A Tri-Nation Series in Sri Lanka, scoring 274 runs, including a sublime century, to help India lift the title.

In this interview with *Sportstar*,

Gaikwad speaks about overcoming injuries, the demands of captaincy, the leadership lessons he learnt from M.S. Dhoni, balancing the three formats and why simplicity remains at the heart of his cricket.

You've often had to wait for opportunities at the highest level. How have you navigated that phase of your career?

Not really challenging. I have a different perspective on it. The IPL itself is a big tournament to be a part of. Obviously, getting to play in that and also playing a series like this is always an opportunity.

Every match you play at the highest level is an opportunity to go somewhere. Even if you're playing for India A, it's an opportunity to stay

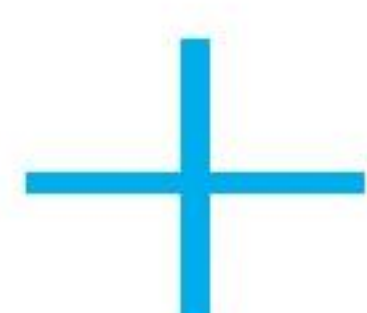
in the team, score runs, and make your case as strong and consistent as possible.

You've had to deal with injuries at key moments in your career. How have those experiences changed your outlook?

Injuries do halt your progress, but they're also not really controllable. Every sportsperson goes through them. Some have very few injuries, while some have a lot. I think I'm somewhere in the middle.

From my side, I try to stay as fit as possible.

As for coming back from injuries and setbacks, it becomes a hunger-driven process. The longer you're out, the more you want to get back on the field, score runs and play



Supporting every player who represents CSK is important. Everyone who plays for CSK feels something special about representing the franchise and wants to do a little more for the team.